

READING PASSAGE 2

The History of Photography

A The History of Photography has emerged as one of the most significant topics in contemporary academic discourse. The complexity and multifaceted nature of this subject have attracted the attention of researchers, policymakers, and practitioners across multiple disciplines, all seeking to understand its implications for the future.

B The intellectual lineage of this field extends considerably further than many realise. While modern research techniques have only recently been applied to these questions, philosophers and natural scientists have grappled with related issues for centuries. The transition from speculative philosophical inquiry to systematic empirical investigation represents one of the most significant developments in the intellectual history of this domain.

C Contemporary research has identified several critical factors that determine outcomes in this domain. The interplay between environmental conditions, technological capabilities, and social organisation creates a complex adaptive system in which small changes can produce disproportionately large effects. Understanding these dynamics requires analytical approaches that move beyond simple cause-and-effect reasoning to embrace the principles of complexity science and systems thinking.

D Case studies from diverse geographical and cultural settings provide compelling illustrations of these dynamics in action. In one particularly well-documented example, researchers tracked developments over a fifteen-year period in a setting that offered a natural experiment in the effects of policy change. The introduction of a new regulatory framework produced a cascade of adaptations that rippled through the entire system, generating outcomes that both confirmed theoretical predictions and revealed previously unrecognised complexities.

E The practical application of research findings has proven more challenging than many initially anticipated. The translation of academic knowledge into actionable policy recommendations requires navigating a complex landscape of political constraints, economic interests, and social dynamics that academic models often simplify or overlook. Implementation failures in several high-profile initiatives have underscored the gap between theoretical understanding and practical capacity, prompting calls for more engaged and context-sensitive approaches to research.

F The implications of this body of research extend well beyond the academy. As societies grapple with increasingly complex challenges, the insights generated by scholarly inquiry in this domain have the potential to inform more effective and equitable policy responses. Realising this potential, however, will require sustained investment in both fundamental research and the translational infrastructure needed to convert knowledge into action.

G The evidence reviewed above demonstrates both the substantial achievements of research in this field and the significant work that remains to be done. As new tools and theoretical perspectives become available, and as the phenomena themselves continue to evolve, the research community will need to maintain both rigour in its methods and openness to new ideas. The stakes are high, for the questions addressed by this research bear directly on some of the most important challenges facing humanity in the twenty-first century.

Question 1

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 1 Contemporary understanding of this topic is more sophisticated than it was fifty years ago.

Question 2

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 2 The author notes that researchers have called for more _____ approaches to investigation.

Questions 3–5

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 3 Early researchers had access to the same technologies as modern scholars.
- 4 The landmark study discussed in the passage involved participants from multiple countries.
- 5 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.

Questions 6–7

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 6 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?
- A. economic incentives and institutional constraints
 - B. individual personality traits
 - C. random chance
 - D. government policies alone
- 7 Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?
- A. economic incentives and institutional constraints
 - B. individual personality traits
 - C. random chance
 - D. government policies alone

Questions 8–9

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 8 According to the text, cognitive processes shape the _____ that people make.

9 According to the passage, structural factors include economic incentives, institutional frameworks, and _____.

Question 10

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

10 The author suggests that early studies in this field were limited by:

- A. economic incentives and institutional constraints
- B. individual personality traits
- C. random chance
- D. government policies alone

Question 11

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

11 Dynamic _____ processes can amplify or dampen initial effects in complex systems.

Questions 12–13

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

12 According to the passage, what is one of the key factors identified by researchers?

- A. excessive research funding
- B. translating academic findings into practical policy
- C. lack of public interest
- D. too many international collaborations

13 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:

- A. economic incentives and institutional constraints
- B. individual personality traits
- C. random chance
- D. government policies alone